

Protea

*The king protea gets
much of the water it
needs from fog!*

Flames can spread quickly through the shrubland of South Africa. Fires are so common where proteas (pro-tee-ahs) live that they have special tricks to survive. Some of them keep seeds in fireproof cases. Others, such as the king protea, have underground buds that stay safe in the earth. Even if the bushes burn to a black crisp, when the fire goes out, they start growing again.

Proteas are found mainly in South Africa. They get their name from Proteus, a sea god in Ancient Greece. He could change his body into many different forms, and these dazzling flowers come in many shapes and colours, too.

